- The class body has three access specifiers (visibility labels) viz., private , public and protected.

14.1.3 Class Access Specifiers

Data hiding is one of the important features of Object Oriented Programming which allows preventing the functions of a program to access directly the internal representation of a class type. The access restriction to the class members is specified by public, private and protected sections within the class body. The keywords public, private and protected are called access specifiers. The default access specifier for members is private.

The Public Members

A public member is accessible from anywhere outside the class but within a program.You can set and get the value of public data members even without using any member function.

The Private Members

A private member cannot be accessed from outside the class. Only the class member functions can access private members.By default all the members of a class would be private.

The Protected Members

A protected member is very similar to a private member but it provides one additional benefit that they can be accessed in child classes which are called derived classes (inherited classes).

Example

```
class student
{
private:
        char name [10];
        int rollno, mark1, mark2, total;
protected:
        void accept();
        void compute();
public:
        void display();
};
```

Keyword class intimates the compiler that it is a class definition

Class name or tag name acts as a user defined data type. Using this, object of the same class type will be created.

These are private access specifier members

That means these members cannot be accessed from outside

These are protected access specifier members

These members also cannot be accessed from outside

Members under this specifier can be accessed from outside

11th Std Computer Science_EM Chapter 14.indd 234 06-01-2023 15:11:50